

Context and quotes

DNS over Avian Carriers (DoAC)

DNS OVER AVIAN CARRIERS (DOAC) · DRAFT-CRUZGONZALEZ-IPOAC-DNS · IETF

1. APRIL 1ST RFCS — HISTORICAL CONTEXT

What an RFC is	An RFC (Request for Comments) is the technical document that defines how the internet works: from how email is delivered to how a browser negotiates a secure connection. They are published by the IETF (Internet Engineering Task Force), the international body responsible for standardizing internet protocols.
The tradition	Since 1989, the IETF has published humorous technical documents every April 1st. They are no less rigorous than any other RFC: they follow the same format, use the standard normative language (MUST, SHOULD, MAY), and are permanently archived in the IETF database. The difference is that their stated purpose is humorous — their technical execution is entirely serious.
RFC 1149 (1990)	"A Standard for the Transmission of IP Datagrams on Avian Carriers" — the foundational document of the avian-carrier saga. It specifies how to transmit internet packets using homing pigeons. Published April 1, 1990, by D. Waitzman.
The 2001 implementation	In April 2001, the Bergen Linux User Group (BLUG) in Norway implemented RFC 1149 with real pigeons. They sent 9 packets; 4 arrived. Packet loss: 55%. Average round-trip time: ~3,000 seconds (~50 minutes). The experiment was considered a success.
The avian-carrier saga	RFC 2549 (1999) added Quality of Service to avian-carrier infrastructure. RFC 6214 (2011) extended support to IPv6. DoAC (2026) closes the last remaining gap: domain name resolution. The avian-carrier protocol stack is, for the first time, complete.
Other notable April RFCs	RFC 2324 (1998): Hyper Text Coffee Pot Control Protocol (HTCPCP) — a protocol for controlling coffee pots over the internet. RFC 3514 (2003): The Evil Bit — proposes adding a bit to IPv4 packets to indicate malicious intent. RFC 5514 (2009): IPv6 over Social Networks.

2. QUOTES FROM THE AUTHOR

The following quotes may be used directly by members of the press, attributed to Christian Elías Cruz González.

ON THE ORIGIN OF THE DOCUMENT

"I came across RFC 1149 in university and found it the most absurd and brilliant thing I'd ever seen. When I discovered that in 2001 a group of Norwegians had actually implemented it — with real pigeons, packet loss and all — I understood that this was something serious dressed as a joke. The avian-carrier protocol stack had been incomplete for decades. Someone had to close the DNS gap."

ON THE IANA CONSIDERATIONS SECTION

"The IANA Considerations section is my favorite. The IETF is used to receiving requests for registries of all kinds. I came in with a long list, and then wrote that I required no action on their part. It's a very specific joke for those who know the process: technically impeccable, internally absurd."

ON THE AAA RECORD

"There's a detail in the document that I find very amusing: I'm reserving the "AAA" record type for future use without defining what it is. If the document is lucky, in a few years someone will have to write an RFC explaining what on earth AAA means in the avian context. That's exactly the kind of ordered chaos that characterizes this tradition."

ON THE DRAFT'S ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

"The document's acknowledgements include a pigeon. Not a metaphorical one — a specific one. It's the kind of detail that either nobody notices, or someone notices and finds very funny. I prefer writing for that second type of person."

ON THE EDUCATIONAL VALUE OF HUMOROUS RFCS

"The avian-carrier saga does something few technical resources manage: it explains how the internet works using a medium anyone can physically imagine. When you read how a packet is transmitted on a pigeon's leg, concepts like latency, packet loss, and name resolution suddenly have real weight. I think these RFCs are a seriously underrated science communication tool."

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FULL DRAFT

datatracker.ietf.org/doc/draft-cruzgonzalez-ipoac-dns/